



FREE GUIDE · FOR CLINICAL & DIAGNOSTIC LABS

The Clinical Lab's Guide to Compliant Waste Disposal.

Specimens, phlebotomy sharps, and hazardous
stains — every stream, handled right.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Biohazard is the backbone.

Clinical and diagnostic labs generate biohazard as the backbone stream — blood and body-fluid specimens, cultures, and contaminated labware — plus high-volume phlebotomy sharps and some hazardous reagents and stains. This guide covers every stream and how to keep the volume moving compliantly.

The good news

One partner can take your specimen biohazard, phlebotomy sharps, and hazardous reagents — mail-back or scheduled pickup — with manifests and Certificates of Destruction. No contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Specimens, cultures, and contaminated labware — your primary stream.



GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Blood & body-fluid specimens
- Cultures & contaminated labware
- Blood tubes & OPIM materials

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — check your state's definition.

WASTE STREAM 02

Sharps

Phlebotomy and lab sharps at volume.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Phlebotomy needles & lancets
- Broken glass & capillary tubes
- Syringes

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

WASTE STREAM 03

Hazardous chemical waste

Hazardous stains, reagents, and fixatives.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Hazardous stains & reagents
- Formalin & fixatives (if used)
- Characteristic hazardous chemicals

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-hazardous waste
- Sharps
- Biohazard / red-bag waste

THE RULE · EPA RCRA and DOT — characterize, segregate by compatibility, manifest, and destroy to EPA standards.

DISPOSE WITH · RCRA-hazardous handling with manifests.

Tip

Characterize your chemicals first — the RCRA listing or characteristic sets the disposal path.

WASTE STREAM 04

Pathological / tissue waste

If your lab processes tissue or pathology specimens.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Tissue & pathology specimens (per state)
- Formalin-fixed tissue
- Biopsy materials

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps
- Non-hazardous waste

THE RULE · State medical-waste rules — pathological waste often has specific handling and destruction requirements.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard / pathological handling per state rules.

Tip

Pathological waste rules vary widely by state — confirm yours before you set a process.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The clinical lab compliance checklist.

- ☐ Specimen and culture biohazard red-bagged and destroyed per state rules.
- ☐ Phlebotomy and lab sharps in FDA-cleared containers, sized to volume.
- ☐ Hazardous stains, reagents, and fixatives characterized and manifested.

- ☐ Tissue/pathology waste handled per your state's specific rules.
- ☐ Staff trained annually on OSHA bloodborne pathogens.
- ☐ Manifests and Certificates of Destruction retained for accreditation and audits.

QUESTIONS LABS ASK

Your clinical lab questions, answered.

How do we handle high phlebotomy sharps volume?

We size sharps kits (or set a pickup cadence) to your draw volume so containers never overfill.

Are stains and fixatives regulated?

Some are — certain stains and formalin can be hazardous chemical waste. We characterize them and manifest what's regulated.

What about tissue and pathology specimens?

They're regulated medical waste with state-specific pathological-waste rules — we'll confirm yours.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle takes your clinical lab's specimen biohazard, phlebotomy sharps, and hazardous reagents — mail-back or scheduled pickup — with manifests and Certificates of Destruction. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Specimens / cultures	Biohazard kit or pickup
Phlebotomy sharps	Sharps mail-back kit
Hazardous stains / fixatives	RCRA-hazardous handling (manifested)
Tissue / pathology	Pathological handling per state

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Lab volume usually favors scheduled pickup with manifests over mail-back. We'll size it — get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY CLINICAL & DIAGNOSTIC LABS CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your clinical lab waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop